

EDUCATION

Pennsylvania State University
Information Sciences and Technology
Ph.D. in Human-Computer Interaction
Grad. Aug 2019

East China Normal University
B.S. in Computer Science
Grad. May 2013

SKILLS

🎓 Research methods

Qualitative:

Interview • Contextual Inquiry • Focus Group • Diary studies • Field Studies • Cognitive Walkthrough • Affinity Diagram • Think-aloud • Usability Test • Literature Review • Scenario Based Design • Design Sprint

Quantitative:

Survey • Experiment Design • Evals • HaTS • Log Analysis • Factor Analysis • Regression • Kano Modeling • TURF Analysis • MaxDiff

</> Programming

Languages:

HTML/CSS • Python • JavaScript • R • SQL • C++

WORK EXPERIENCE

Google Oct 2019 – Present
Senior UX Researcher | Google Workspace & Core Data Sunnyvale, CA

GenAI Productivity Ecosystem Executive Influence

- **AI Boosted Work Productivity:** Pioneered enterprise GenAI productivity research, formulating a value framework beyond "time savings" that pivoted go-to-market strategy; delivered executive briefs and authored peer-reviewed research (ACM DIS 2025) on knowledge worker adoption.
- **ImageGen Editor 0-to-1 UXR:** Led end-to-end exploratory and evaluative research for multimodal AI creation tools (announced in Google I/O 2026) across Dogfood, external Consumer and Business tiers; established Evals rubrics, in-product HaTS to directly de-risk and steer the General Availability (GA) launch.
- **Ecosystem Extensibility & Workflow Automation:** Spearheaded research for cross-platform Workflow Automation and 3P Extensibility Primitives, defining trigger-action CUJs and fielding survey to prioritize top 3P partner integrations (e.g., ServiceNow, Jira), accelerating platform adoption and prioritizing business partner development.
- **Unified API & Metrics Scaling:** Scaled Workspace Platform HaTS program by 560% (from 5 to 33 APIs in collaboration with Eng, tech writer, DevRel teams).

Access Governance Data Sharing & Group Infrastructure

- **Access Governance:** Lead foundational research on Authorization (AuthZ) role management across Enterprise and SMB segments; identified critical security risks in over-granted permissions, shaping product roadmaps for granular role delegation and just-in-time (JIT) access.
- **External Data Sharing:** Established the cross-product UX foundation for Guest Pass collaboration across Chat, Drive, and Admin Console; defined external data-sharing boundaries and guest labeling, unblocking successful Alpha and GA launches.
- **UGC Data Solutions & Storage Infrastructure (ContribService):** Drove usability studies for high-scale UGC Data Infrastructure, resulting in a +37% Task Success Rate and +8 user sentiment points, securing executive approval for GA.

Airbnb May – Aug 2018
User Experience Research Intern San Francisco, CA

- Drove research and redesign to increase the booking rate of new listings, and quantified the business value of new hosts' community involvement on their long-term hosting journey.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Sun, N., & Kalar, D. Gemini at Work: Knowledge Workers' Perceptions and Assessment of Productivity Gains. Proceedings of the 2025 ACM Designing Interactive Systems Conference (**DIS 2025**) [Acceptance: 25%]

Sun, N., Wang, X. Y., & Rosson, M. B. How Do Distance Learners Connect? Proceedings of the 37th annual ACM conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (**CHI 2019**) [Best Paper Honourable Mention Award: top 4%]

Sun, N., Rosson, M. B., & Carroll, J. M. Where is Community Among Online Learners? Identity, Efficacy and Personal Ties. Proceedings of the 36th annual ACM conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (**CHI 2018**) [Acceptance: 25.7%]